

# Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

## US expands boat strikes to Pacific

Official: 2 or 3 dead on suspected drug vessel off Colombia

By Eric Schmitt and Charlie Savage  
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — The U.S. military attacked another vessel that the government suspected was carrying drugs, but for the

first time struck a boat in the eastern Pacific Ocean off the coast of Colombia rather than in the Caribbean Sea, a U.S. official said Wednesday.

The strike, late Tuesday, killed two or three people on the boat, said the official, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss operational matters.

This was the eighth known strike that U.S. Special Operations forces have conducted since Sept.

2, when the military, on President Donald Trump's orders, began killing people aboard boats believed to be smuggling drugs as if they were enemy combatants in a war rather than criminal suspects.

The administration has previously acknowledged seven strikes, which it said have killed 32 people. It has not yet announced the latest strike, which was reported earlier by CBS News.

The Trump administration's

policy of attacking suspected drug runners began with a focus on Venezuela. Officials are also weighing whether to intensify an effort to remove Venezuela's president, Nicolás Maduro, who was indicted on drug trafficking charges in the United States in 2020 and whom the Trump team calls a cartel leader.

But in the interim, the boat attacks have increasingly encompassed Colombia, which is a far

greater source of narcotics smuggled to the United States than Venezuela. Colombian President Gustavo Petro has said several strikes had killed Colombians and accused the United States of murder. Trump has said he was cutting off foreign aid to Colombia in response.

The Trump administration has said that each of the seven previous

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Tina Rosales folds laundry at Smart Wash Laundry on Wednesday in Chicago. An hour earlier, federal agents surrounded the laundromat but were not let inside by workers. Rosales has been going to the laundromat for more than two decades and said, "I'm OK, but this is still my community, these are still my people and I worry about them." STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

## Immigration agents swarm into Little Village, Cicero

At least 7 arrested, including US citizens

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Talia Soglin, Gregory Royal Pratt and Madeline Buckley  
Chicago Tribune

Federal immigration agents accompanied by Border Patrol chief Gregory Bovino swarmed Chicago's Little Village neighborhood Wednesday, community leaders said, arresting at least seven people, including U.S. citizens, and clashing with residents who filmed them.

The operation caused chaos in one of Chicago's oldest and largest immigrant communities — known as "Mexico of the Midwest" — and neighboring Cicero, with the agents' presence

sparking fear at a local laundromat, a Sam's Club and the popular El Milagro restaurant and tortillería on 26th Street.

Among those taken into custody were two street vendors and a man who left his home to do laundry. A social media video also appeared to show Border Patrol agents, with Bovino present, detaining a woman during a confrontation with onlookers.

Community leaders and elected officials condemned the raids Wednesday afternoon, saying agents trespassed on private property to effect arrests.

"Our communities are not a



Federal agents, including Border Patrol chief Gregory Bovino, descend Wednesday on Smart Wash Laundry, in the 3100 block of South Pulaski Avenue in Chicago's Little Village neighborhood. TINA ROSALES

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## Attorney speaks out after arrest

Says feds pointed guns at him in Oak Park, had 'Chirag Team 2' chat

By Rebecca Johnson  
Chicago Tribune

While Scott Sakiyama was being arrested by federal immigration officers outside his child's Oak Park elementary school this week, he had what he could only describe as an out-of-body experience.

Sakiyama, a 46-year-old U.S. citizen, was accused of "cutting off (an) agent's vehicle" and "impeding (a) federal officer," according to a citation he was later issued. Sakiyama, an attorney, told the Tribune these charges are a "complete fabrication" and that he was merely driving behind the vehicle, honking his horn and blowing a whistle to warn neighbors of their presence.

Sakiyama said two agents drew guns on him — steps away from Abraham Lincoln Elementary School — and told him that if he didn't step out of the car they would break his windows. While a video filmed by a witness doesn't capture the events leading up to the confrontation, it shows the agents approaching Sakiyama's vehicle and at least one of them appearing to point a weapon from the passenger side of the car.

He's then handcuffed and led away. The nearby school went into what it calls a "secure" status.

"I was very much focused on just not moving and not being escalatory in any way," he said. "So it was kind of like a disembodied but also focused feeling."

The Department of Homeland Security didn't respond to requests for comment on the arrest, but officials have previously said violence against agents has increased during its latest immigration enforcement push. Some residents, however, have spoken out against increasingly aggressive tactics used by officers during the crackdown, particu-

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ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE

### For starters, some hope

Bulls have chance to make waves in Eastern Conference if they can do little things well, Paul Sullivan writes.  
Chicago Sports

### US announces new sanctions on Russia

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced new sanctions on Russia's two biggest oil companies.  
Nation & World

## Pritzker, GOP House Leader McCombie bickered in texts

By Olivia Olander and Dan Petrella  
Chicago Tribune

When a right-wing provocateur last month posted a video outside Gov. JB Pritzker's Chicago home encouraging viewers to "take action" after conservative activist Charlie Kirk's assassination, the governor reached out to both Republican leaders of the Illinois legislature.

"I'm dealing with vastly increased threats on my family and myself in the wake of this week and this Republican Trumper went to my house, suggested that I'm taking God out of public life

and encouraged people to 'take action,'" the governor texted separately to Illinois Senate Leader John Curran and House Leader Tony McCombie. "I'd like to see condemnation of this from GOP leaders today."

What followed was not exactly what Pritzker sought.

Instead, he and McCombie, who are typically cordial in texts to each other, exchanged heated messages as McCombie rebuffed the governor's request and called out Pritzker for some of his previous comments about Republicans, with the governor shooting

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House Minority Leader Rep. Tony McCombie gives a GOP response after Gov. JB Pritzker delivered his budget address in Springfield on Feb. 19.  
BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

